

Absolutely — **runner** gets the same full-depth treatment as **guest**, with the second-pass audit already built in. I'm following the uploaded SOP's rule to search broadly across ordinary, figurative, technical, compound, and family-extension uses, but to merge contexts that share the same underlying concept rather than inflating the meaning count.

Because **run** itself is already in your mapped database, I will **not** recreate the whole run family here. This entry focuses on **runner** and the useful lexicalized compounds/extensions that deserve separate learner attention.

Word family: **runner / runners / runner-up / front-runner**

Base word: runner

Plural: runners

Base verb: run — already curated separately

Useful extensions: runner-up, front-runner

Useful compounds: distance runner, middle-distance runner, long-distance runner, road runner, trail runner, food runner, errand runner, drug runner, table runner, carpet runner, plant runner, base runner, test runner, job runner

Part of speech: noun

Your sentence

> “Having spent the past twelve years as a professional middle-distance **runner**, I am now seeking a career change...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **runner** means a person who **runs competitively as an athlete**, specifically in middle-distance track events.

Middle-distance running normally refers to races that require a combination of speed and endurance rather than pure sprinting or very long-distance endurance.

繁體中文：

以跑步項目參加競技運動的人；在本句中特別指專業參加中距離賽跑的運動員

中文翻譯：

> 「過去十二年，我一直是一名專業中距離**跑手 / 賽跑運動員**，現在希望轉換職業……」

middle-distance runner = 專門參加中距離賽跑項目的跑手 / 田徑運動員

1. runner — person who runs, especially for sport — 跑步者；跑手

The central meaning is a person who runs, particularly for exercise, sport, or competition.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I spent twelve years as a professional middle-distance **runner**.”

「我有十二年擔任專業中距離**跑手**的經驗。」

Practice 2

> “Hundreds of **runners** took part in the charity race.”

「數百名**跑手**參加了慈善賽跑。」

Practice 3

> “She is a strong **runner** with excellent endurance.”

「她是一名耐力出色的**跑手**。」

runner = 以跑步作為運動、鍛鍊或比賽活動的人

2. runner — competitive racing athlete — 賽跑運動員

A **runner** can more specifically mean an athlete who competes in running events.

Practice 4

> “The **runner** qualified for the national championships.”

「那名**賽跑運動員**取得全國錦標賽參賽資格。」

Practice 5

> “Elite **runners** monitor their training and recovery carefully.”

「精英**跑手**會仔細監察自己的訓練和恢復情況。」

runner = 正式參與田徑、公路跑或其他賽跑比賽的運動員

Curation note

I would **not** treat:

- * recreational runner
- * marathon runner
- * track runner
- * professional runner

as unrelated meanings.

They all share the same core concept:

> ****a person who runs as an activity or sport****

3. middle-distance runner — 中距離跑手

This is your exact compound.

A ****middle-distance runner**** specializes in races between sprint and long-distance events.

Practice 6

> “She trained as a ****middle-distance runner**** throughout university.”

「她整個大學時期都以****中距離跑手****身分接受訓練。」

Practice 7

> “A middle-distance runner needs both speed and endurance.”

「****中距離跑手****同時需要速度和耐力。」

****middle-distance runner = 專門參加需要結合速度與耐力的中距離跑步項目的運動員****

This is a compound branch, not a separate lexical meaning of bare ****runner****.

4. distance runner — 中長距離 / 耐力跑手

A broad sporting term for someone specializing in races where endurance plays a major role.

> “Distance ****runners**** usually complete substantial aerobic training.”

「****中長距離 / 耐力跑手****通常會進行大量帶氧訓練。」

5. long-distance runner — 長跑運動員；長距離跑手

Practice 8

> “She became a successful long-distance **runner**.”

「她成為一名成功的**長距離跑手**。」

Practice 9

> “Long-distance runners must manage fatigue carefully.”

「**長跑運動員**必須小心管理疲勞。」

6. runner — participant currently running in a race — 參賽跑手

Runner can refer to any competitor in a running race, whether professional or not.

Practice 10

> “The first **runner** crossed the finish line in under ten minutes.”

「第一名**參賽跑手**在十分鐘內衝過終點。」

Practice 11

> “Officials gave water to the **runners** along the route.”

「工作人員沿途向**參賽跑手**派水。」

Again, this belongs to the main human-running sense.

7. runner — person who carries messages/items or performs errands — 跑腿人員；傳遞員

A very different occupational sense.

A **runner** can be someone whose job is to carry:

- * messages
- * documents
- * food

- * equipment
- * supplies

between people or places.

Practice 12

> “The production team sent a **runner** to collect the equipment.”

「製作團隊派了一名**跑腿工作人員**去取設備。」

Practice 13

> “He started in the film industry as a **runner**.”

「他最初在電影業擔任**跑腿助理 / 基層製作助理**。」

runner = 負責快速傳遞物件、訊息或完成各種臨時差事的工作人員

This is particularly common in:

- * film/TV production
- * events
- * offices
- * restaurants

8. food runner — 傳菜員

In restaurants, a **food runner** carries completed dishes from the kitchen to customers' tables.

Practice 14

> “The **food runner** brought the dishes to our table.”

「**傳菜員**把菜送到我們桌上。」

Practice 15

> “Food runners work closely with servers and kitchen staff.”

「**傳菜員**會與侍應和廚房員工密切合作。」

food runner = 負責把已準備好的食物從廚房送到客人餐桌的員工

This is a useful modern hospitality compound.

9. errand runner — 跑腿人員；代辦雜務的人

Someone who performs small practical tasks or errands for others.

Practice 16

> “He worked as an **errand runner** for the office.”

「他為辦公室擔任**跑腿雜務人員**。」

Practice 17

> “The assistant became an unofficial errand runner for the whole team.”

「那名助理漸漸成為整個團隊非正式的**跑腿人員**。」

10. runner — courier/smuggler moving illegal goods — 運送者；偷運者

In criminal or illicit contexts, **runner** can mean someone who transports prohibited or illegal goods, money, or messages.

Common examples include:

* drug runner

* gun runner

* money runner

Practice 18

> “Police arrested a suspected drug **runner**.”

「警方拘捕了一名涉嫌替人運送毒品的**偷運者 / 運毒者**。」

Practice 19

> “The organization used **runners** to move money across the border.”

「該組織利用**運送人員**把金錢帶過邊境。」

****runner = 替某人或組織快速運送違禁品、金錢或其他物品的人****

Register note

This use often appears in:

- * crime reporting
- * law enforcement
- * fiction

The underlying link with Meaning 7 is still “someone who carries things from place to place,” but the criminal context is important enough to flag.

11. runner — person moving between bases in baseball — 跑壘員

In baseball, a **runner** or **base runner / baserunner** is a player who is advancing between bases.

Practice 20

> “The **runner** reached second base safely.”

「那名**跑壘員**安全到達二壘。」

Practice 21

> “There were runners on first and third.”

「一壘和三壘都有**跑壘員**。」

runner = 棒球中正在各壘之間推進、試圖得分的進攻球員

This is a genuine sports-domain meaning.

12. runner — long narrow rug — 長條地毯；走廊地毯

A **runner** can be a long, narrow carpet or rug, especially one laid along:

- * a hallway
- * staircase
- * passage

Practice 22

> “A red **runner** covered the hallway floor.”

「走廊地面鋪著一條紅色**長條地毯**。」

Practice 23

> “They placed a carpet **runner** on the stairs.”

「他們在樓梯鋪了一條**長條地毯**。」

runner = 用於走廊、樓梯等狹長空間的長而窄地毯

Completely different from a person who runs.

13. table runner — 桌旗；長條桌布

A long narrow strip of decorative fabric placed along a table.

Practice 24

> “She placed a linen **table runner** along the centre of the table.”

「她在桌子中央鋪了一條亞麻**桌旗 / 長條桌布**。」

Practice 25

> “The table runner matched the napkins.”

「**桌旗**與餐巾的顏色很相配。」

table runner = 沿桌面長方向鋪放的窄長裝飾布

A very useful household compound.

14. runner — spreading plant stem — 匍匐莖；走莖

In botany/gardening, a **runner** is a long stem that grows horizontally from a plant and can produce new plants.

Strawberries are a classic example.

Practice 26

> “The strawberry plant produced several **runners**.”

「這株草莓長出了幾條**匍匐莖 / 走莖**。」

Practice 27

> “New plants developed from the **runners**.”

「新的植株從這些**走莖**長出來。」

runner = 從母株橫向延伸並可生長出新植株的細長莖部

This is a strong, genuinely distinct biology/gardening sense.

15. runner — sliding/supporting strip or track — 滑軌；滑條

A **runner** can be a narrow supporting or sliding component along which something moves.

This appears in objects such as:

- * drawers
- * curtains
- * sliding mechanisms

Practice 28

> “The drawer **runner** needs to be replaced.”

「抽屜的**滑軌**需要更換。」

Practice 29

> “One of the curtain runners is broken.”

「其中一個窗簾**滑動配件 / 滑扣**壞了。」

runner = 讓物件沿固定方向滑動或移動的狹長支撐 / 導引部件

This is useful household/technical vocabulary, though lower priority than the main senses.

16. runner — blade/support beneath a sled — 雪橇滑板；滑行部件

The long narrow part underneath a sled or similar object that slides over snow or ice can be called a **runner**.

Practice 30

> “One of the sled’s **runners** was damaged.”

「雪橇其中一條**滑板 / 滑行條**損壞了。」

Practice 31

> “The metal runners allowed the sled to move smoothly over the snow.”

「金屬**滑板**讓雪橇能在雪上順暢滑行。」

runner = 雪橇底部與地面接觸、讓其滑行的狹長部分

This develops from the idea of something that “runs” along a surface.

17. runner — software/process that executes jobs or tests — 執行器；執行程序

In modern computing, a **runner** can be a program, service, machine, or agent that executes automated jobs.

Common examples:

- * CI runner
- * test runner
- * job runner
- * workflow runner

Practice 32

> “The test **runner** executes all the automated tests.”

「測試**執行器**會執行所有自動化測試。」

Practice 33

> “The build failed because the CI **runner** was offline.”

「由於 CI **執行器 / 執行節點**離線，建置失敗了。」

****runner = 負責自動接收並執行程式、測試、工作或自動化流程的軟件 / 系統元件****

This is an increasingly important technology meaning.

18. test runner — 測試執行器

A program responsible for discovering and running automated tests.

Practice 34

> “The ****test runner**** displayed the failed tests.”

「****測試執行器****顯示了失敗的測試項目。」

Practice 35

> “You can configure the test runner from this file.”

「你可以透過這個檔案設定****測試執行器****。」

19. runner-up — 第二名；亞軍

A ****runner-up**** is a person or team that finishes immediately behind the winner.

This is a highly important lexical extension.

Practice 36

> “She finished as ****runner-up**** in the championship.”

「她在錦標賽中取得****亞軍****。」

Practice 37

> “The runners-up received silver medals.”

「****亞軍選手****獲頒銀牌。」

****runner-up = 比賽、競選或評選中排名緊接冠軍 / 勝出者之後的人或隊伍****

Plural note

Both forms are encountered, but standard careful English commonly uses:

runners-up

because **runner** is the main noun.

> one runner-up

> two runners-up

20. front-runner — 領先者；大熱門

A person, team, product, or candidate that is currently leading or widely considered among the strongest contenders.

Practice 38

> “She quickly became the **front-runner** for the award.”

「她很快成為該獎項的**領先熱門人選**。」

Practice 39

> “The company is a front-runner in battery technology.”

「這家公司是電池科技領域的**領先者**。」

front-runner = 在競爭、評選或某個發展領域中處於領先位置的人 / 事物

This can be literal competition or figurative professional competition.

21. front-runner — leading competitor in an actual race — 領跑者

Practice 40

> “The front-runner increased her lead on the final lap.”

「**領跑者**在最後一圈進一步拉開領先距離。」

Practice 41

> “The early front-runner eventually finished third.”

「早段的**領跑選手**最後取得第三名。」

This is the more literal source of the broader figurative meaning.

22. do a runner — 逃走；溜掉；不付錢離開

A common informal British expression.

Practice 42

> “The customer ate the meal and then **did a runner** without paying.”

「那名顧客吃完飯後**沒有付款便溜走了**。」

Practice 43

> “He realized the police were coming and did a runner.”

「他發現警察快到了，於是**逃走了**。」

do a runner = 突然逃走或偷偷離開，尤其為了逃避付款、責任或麻煩

This is a fixed expression and cannot be understood simply as “做一個跑手”.

Important distinctions

runner vs athlete

athlete

is broader and can refer to someone competing in many kinds of sport.

runner

specifically emphasizes running.

Therefore:

> every professional middle-distance runner is an athlete,

but:

> not every athlete is a runner.

runner vs jogger

runner

broader; can be recreational or competitive and may run at any training intensity.

jogger

usually suggests someone running at an easy/moderate pace for exercise.

> "She is a competitive runner."

sounds natural.

> "She is a competitive jogger."

normally does not express the same athletic concept.

runner vs sprinter

runner

general category

sprinter

runner specializing in short, high-speed races

So:

****sprinter = a type of runner****

middle-distance runner vs long-distance runner

middle-distance runner

needs a strong combination of:

- * speed
- * endurance
- * tactical racing

long-distance runner

generally relies more heavily on sustained endurance.

These are sporting subcategories, not separate meanings of **runner**.

runner vs courier

Both may carry things between places.

courier

specifically focuses on delivering packages, documents, or messages.

runner

often describes a more general junior/support person completing miscellaneous tasks quickly.

In film production:

> runner

is especially idiomatic.

runner vs waiter/server

In restaurants:

food runner

primarily transports dishes from kitchen to table.

server / waiter

normally takes orders, communicates with customers, and provides broader table service.

The jobs can overlap depending on the restaurant.

runner vs carpet

A **runner** is not just another word for any carpet.

A runner is normally:

> **long and narrow**

and designed for a narrow space such as:

* hallway

* staircase

runner vs runner-up

Very important:

runner

= someone who runs

runner-up

= someone who finishes immediately behind the winner

A **runner-up** does **not** need to be a literal runner.

> “She was runner-up in a singing competition.”

perfectly natural.

runner-up vs second place

They often correspond, but the grammar differs.

> “She was the runner-up.”

= 她是亞軍。

> “She finished in second place.”

= 她取得第二名。

****runner-up**** identifies the person/team.

****second place**** identifies the ranking.

front-runner vs runner-up

front-runner

leading contender ****before or during the result being decided****

runner-up

person/team that actually ****finishes immediately behind the winner****

A front-runner can ultimately win, lose, or even finish much lower.

Important countability note

****runner**** is normally countable:

> one runner

> two runners

Compound nouns remain countable:

> one food runner

> several test runners

Family-extension sweep

Because ****run**** is already mapped separately in your database, I would not duplicate its enormous family here. For ****runner****, the useful modern material is:

* ****runner — sport/exercise**** = 跑手 / 跑步者

* ****competitive runner**** = 賽跑運動員

* ****middle-distance runner**** = 中距離跑手

* ****long-distance runner**** = 長跑運動員

* **runner — race participant** = 參賽跑手
 * **runner — errand/support worker** = 跑腿 / 傳遞人員
 * **food runner** = 傳菜員
 * **errand runner** = 跑腿人員
 * **runner — illicit courier** = 運送 / 偷運違禁品的人
 * **base runner** = 跑壘員
 * **carpet runner** = 長條地毯
 * **table runner** = 桌旗 / 長條桌布
 * **runner — plant** = 匍匐莖 / 走莖
 * **runner — sliding track/component** = 滑軌 / 滑條
 * **runner — sled component** = 雪橇滑板
 * **runner — computing** = 工作 / 測試執行器
 * **test runner** = 測試執行器
 * **runner-up** = 亞軍
 * **front-runner** = 領跑者 / 領先熱門
 * **do a runner** = 偷偷逃走 / 溜掉

I would stop there. Industrial senses such as specialised moulding/casting **runners** exist, but they move into narrower engineering terminology and would add less value for the general learner standard you've established.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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runner — sport/exercise	以跑步作為運動、鍛鍊或比賽活動的人
runner — competitive athlete	正式參與田徑、公路跑等賽跑項目的運動員
middle-distance runner	專門參加需要結合速度和耐力的中距離賽跑項目的運動員
long-distance runner	專門參加以持續耐力為主要要求的長距離賽跑運動員
runner — race participant	正在參加某項跑步比賽的參賽者
runner — errand/support worker	負責傳遞物品、訊息或迅速完成各種臨時差事的人員
food runner	負責把廚房完成的食物送到客人餐桌的員工
runner — illicit courier	替他人或組織運送違禁品、金錢等物品的人
base runner	棒球中正在各壘之間推進並試圖得分的進攻球員
runner — carpet	鋪於走廊或樓梯等狹長空間的長而窄地毯
table runner	沿桌面長方向鋪放的窄長裝飾布
runner — plant	從母株橫向延伸並能產生新植株的匍匐莖 / 走莖
runner — sliding component	供抽屜、窗簾等沿固定方向滑動的導引 / 支撐部件
runner — sled	雪橇底部接觸雪面並使其滑行的狹長部件
runner — computing	自動接收並執行程式、工作、測試或流程的軟件 / 系統元件
test runner	專門發現並執行自動化測試的程式或工具
runner-up	比賽、評選或競爭中排名緊接勝出者之後的人 / 隊伍；亞軍
front-runner	在競賽或競爭中目前領先或被視為主要熱門的人 / 事物

| **do a runner** | 突然逃走或偷偷離開，以逃避付款、責任或麻煩 |

For your original sentence

> “Having spent the past twelve years as a professional middle-distance **runner**...”

The exact meaning is:

****runner = 以跑步作為專業競技運動並參加正式賽事的運動員****

More specifically:

****middle-distance runner = 專門參加中距離田徑賽事、需要同時具備速度、耐力和比賽策略的跑手****

So the natural Traditional Chinese is:

> ****「專業中距離跑手 / 專業中距離賽跑運動員」****

Here ****runner**** has nothing to do with a ****food runner****, ****carpet runner****, ****plant runner****, ****software runner****, or ****runner-up****—which is exactly why it is a worthwhile polysemy target.